

Dacheng Xu

徐大成

+1 (646) 461 0213
dacheng.xu@columbia.edu
dachengx.github.io
in LinkedIn
dachengx
ORCID
Google Scholar
arXiv
INSPIRE HEP
Last updated: October 3, 2026

Education

- 2022.08–now **Doctor of Philosophy in Physics, Columbia University**
Dissertation: Search for Light Dark Matter near the ^8B Solar Neutrino Fog with XENONnT and a Krypton Background Measurement System at ppq Sensitivity
Advisor: Prof. Elena Aprile
- 2018.08–2022.08 **Bachelor of Engineering (Major: Engineering Physics), Tsinghua University**
Dissertation: Probing Coherent Elastic Neutrino–Nucleus Scattering from Reactor Neutrinos with LXeTPC and HPGe Detectors
Advisor: Prof. Fei Gao & Prof. Litao Yang

Selected Research Experience

XENONnT Dark Matter Project

- 2025–now **Krypton Background Measurement System**
Develop a system to measure the krypton background in xenon at ppq-level sensitivity
○ Commission a cold-trap system to isolate Krypton from xenon for residual-gas-analyzer-based measurement
○ Improve sensitivity to solar pp neutrinos and heavy WIMP searches
- 2022–2026 **Solar ^8B CE ν NS and Light Dark Matter Search**
Signal–background modeling and statistical inference for solar neutrino and light dark matter searches
○ First indication of solar ^8B neutrino CE ν NS and light dark matter search in the presence of “neutrino fog”
○ Corresponding author of two PRL publications and main contributor to one more
- 2024–2026 **Analysis Coordinator of XENONnT**
Coordinated analysis efforts with focus on real-data provisioning and analysis software infrastructure
○ Coordinated analysis activities across multiple working groups, ensuring efficient communication
○ Ensured timely delivery and reliability of collaboration-wide analyses
- 2024 **Convener of Computing and Analysis Tools Group**
Led development of computing and analysis software infrastructure
○ Developed and maintained HTC/HPC processing pipeline with 5 PB IO
○ Designed a data-reprocessing workflow with improved stability adopted for latest XENONnT analyses
- 2023–2024 **Toy-MC Inference Framework**
Developed the open-source statistical inference framework for toy-MC based confidence interval constructions
○ Designed a scalable, modular framework for large-scale toy-MC inference integrated with HPC workflows
○ Adopted by multiple analyses (heavy WIMP, solar ^8B and pp neutrinos, etc.) and external collaborations
- 2022–2023 **GPU-based LXe Response Simulation and Inference**
Developed a open-source simulation and Bayesian inference framework for liquid xenon detector response
○ Rewrote CUDA (C++) framework into JAX (Python) for improved usability and maintainability
○ Enabled Bayesian inference with MCMC, widely used in dark matter and neutrino analyses in XENONnT
- Jinping Neutrino Experiment (JNE)
- 2019–2021 **PMT Waveform Analysis for Neutrino Detection**
Developed waveform analysis methods to reconstruct photon timing and charge for MeV-neutrino measurements
○ Improved time and charge resolution, enabling robust downstream analyses
○ Applied statistical learning methods to enhance the charge resolution in low-occupancy regimes

Gamma-Ray Integrated Detectors (GRID)

2018–2022 **CubeSat Gamma-ray Transient Events Analysis**

Developed a data processing pipeline for CubeSat-based gamma-ray bursts (GRBs) monitoring

- Enabled the detection of over 40 GRBs as of 2025
- Built simulation framework for light curve and localization algorithm development

Selected Honors and Awards

2022.03 **Grand Prize of the 17th “Challenge Cup” Competition**, *Ministry of Education, etc.*

Student Extracurricular Academic and Technological Works Competition

Project: GRID-02 satellite payload calibration and scientific results

2021.12 & **Dongchang He Prize**, *Tsinghua University*

2019.12 Highest award for undergraduate of the Department of Engineering Physics, achieved twice

2020.12 **NAOC Fellowship**, *National Astronomy Observatory of China, Chinese Academy of Sciences*

Three winners per year in Tsinghua University, for students in the field of astronomy nationwide

2020.12 **BOEING Scholarship**, *Tsinghua University*

Excellent Comprehensive Scholarship of Tsinghua University

Talks

Conferences

2026.07 **Talk: Probing the Solar Boron-8 Neutrino Fog with XENONnT**, *Max-Planck-Institut für Kernphysik, Heidelberg, Germany*

Magnificent CEvNS 2026

2026.06 **Poster: Measurement of Solar ^8B Neutrino CE ν NS with XENONnT**, *University of California, Irvine, Irvine, US*

Neutrino 2026: XXXII International Conference on Neutrino Physics and Astrophysics

2026.05 **Poster (People’s Choice Award): XTRACT: The Measurement of Krypton in Xenon with ppq Sensitivity (public PDF)**, *TRIUMF, Vancouver, Canada*

XeSAT 2026 - International Workshop on Applications of Noble Gas Xenon to Science and Technology

2025.06 **Talk: A measurement of the Solar Boron-8 Neutrino Fog with XENONnT**, *Centro Brasileiro de Pesquisas Físicas, Rio de Janeiro, Brazil (online)*

Magnificent CEvNS 2025

2025.06 **Talk: Data processing in XENONnT dark matter project**, *University of Wisconsin-Madison, Madison, US (online)*

Throughput Computing 2025

2024.10 **Talk: First Measurement of Solar ^8B Neutrinos via Coherent Elastic Neutrino-Nucleus Scattering with XENONnT**, *Blois, France*

Blois 2024: 35th Rencontres de Blois on “Particle Physics and Cosmology”

2024.07 **Talk: Search for Coherent Elastic Scattering of Solar ^8B Neutrinos in the XENONnT**, *Shandong University, Qingdao, China*

The 14th Conference of High Energy Physics Branch of Chinese Physical Society

2021.08 **Poster: Accurate and Robust PMT Waveform Analysis**, *Shandong University, Qingdao, China (online)*

The 13th Conference of High Energy Physics Branch of Chinese Physical Society

2021.06 **Poster: Optimized PMT Waveform Analysis**, *University of Minnesota Twin Cities, Minneapolis, US (online)*

The 28th International Workshop on Weak Interactions and Neutrinos (WIN2021)

2020.08 **Talk: PMT waveform analysis in neutrino experiments**, *Lawrence Berkeley National Laboratory, Berkeley, US (online)*

Dark-matter and Neutrino Computation Explored (DANCE) Machine Learning Workshop 2020

Seminars

- 2026.09 **Venturing Into the Neutrino Fog: Solar Boron-8 Neutrinos and Light Dark Matter with XENONnT**, *Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Cambridge, US*, Laboratory for Nuclear Science (LNS) Lunchtime Seminars at MIT
- 2026.09 **Turning a Dark Matter Detector into a Neutrino Observatory: Latest Results from XENONnT**, *Yale University, New Haven, US*, Nuclear Particle Astrophysics (NPA) Seminar at Yale
- 2026.08 **Probing the Solar ^8B Neutrino Fog with XENONnT**, *Lawrence Berkeley National Laboratory, Berkeley, US*, Institute for Nuclear and Particle Astrophysics (INPA) Seminar at LBNL
- 2026.07 **Probing the Solar ^8B Neutrino Fog with XENONnT**, *University College London, London, UK*, HEP seminar at UCL
- 2026.03 **Latest solar neutrino and light WIMP search with XENONnT**, *Washington University in St. Louis, St. Louis, US*, WUCAP
- 2025.12 **Latest solar neutrino and WIMP search results from the XENONnT experiment**, *Kavli Institute for the Physics and Mathematics of the Universe, Kashiwa, Japan*
- 2025.12 **Latest solar neutrino and WIMP search results from the XENONnT experiment**, *Institute for Basic Science, Daejeon, Korea*
- 2025.04 **Venturing into the Neutrino Fog with XENONnT**, *SLAC National Accelerator Laboratory, Menlo Park, US*
- 2024.09 **A measurement of solar neutrino with XENONnT experiment**, *Stony Brook University, Stony Brook, US*
- 2024.09 **First Measurement of Solar ^8B Neutrinos via Coherent Elastic Neutrino-Nucleus Scattering with XENONnT**, *Brookhaven National Laboratory, Upton, US*, Particle Physics Seminars at BNL

Schools

- 2026.08 **Quantum Probes for a Quantum Universe (54th SLAC Summer Institute)**, *SLAC National Accelerator Laboratory, Menlo Park, US*
- 2026.07 **Qiskit Global Summer School 2026: A Decade on the Cloud (Quantum Excellence Badge)**, *IBM Quantum (online)*

Mentoring

- 2025 **Khushi Vandra**, *Columbia University*, NSF Research Experiences for Undergraduates (REU) S1 pulse shape discrimination in liquid xenon detectors

Teaching

- 2024 **Lecturer for XENONnT Computing Tutorial Series**, *Online*
Biweekly tutorial sessions on HTC/HPC computing in XENONnT context
- 2022–2025 **Teaching Assistant**, *Columbia University*, Six Semesters
Intermediate Laboratory Work
Weekly lab sessions at E. K. A. advanced physics lab, covering topics in optics, quantum and particle physics

Internships

- 2024.07 & 2026.01 & 2026.07 **Visiting Researcher**, *Laboratori Nazionali del Gran Sasso, Assergi, Italy*
Operation and calibration shift for XENONnT
- 2021 **Undergraduate Researcher**, *Columbia University*, Summer Undergraduate Research
Data analysis on the XENON detector, including several signal selection criteria
Supervisor: Prof. Elena Aprile

Outreach Activities

2021–2026 **Open-source Projects Maintainer**, *Columbia University*
Promoted open and accessible use of XENONnT analysis tools across collaborations

Professional Services

2024–now **Journal Referee**
Journal of Instrumentation, Physical Review Applied

References

Elena Aprile, *Centennial Professor of Physics*, Columbia University
Ph.D. advisor & XENON Spokesperson, Email: ea18@columbia.edu

Laura Baudis, *Professor of Physics*, University of Zurich
XENON Collaborator, Email: laura.baudis@physik.uzh.ch

Luca Grandi, *Professor of Physics*, The University of Chicago
XENON Collaborator, Email: lgrandi@uchicago.edu

Kaixuan Ni, *Professor of Physics*, University of California San Diego
XENON Collaborator, Email: nikx@physics.ucsd.edu

Fei Gao, *Associate Professor of Physics*, Tsinghua University
B.Eng. advisor, Email: feigao@mail.tsinghua.edu.cn

For a complete publications list, please refer to my INSPIRE profile.

Selected Publications

- [1] E. Aprile et al. Probing the Solar ^8B Neutrino Fog with XENONnT. *Phys. Rev. Lett.*, 137(9):091807, 2026. **Corresponding Author**.
- [2] E. Aprile et al. WIMP Dark Matter Search Using a 3.1 Tonne-Year Exposure of the XENONnT Experiment. *Phys. Rev. Lett.*, 135(22):221003, 2025.
- [3] E. Aprile et al. Low-energy nuclear recoil calibration of XENONnT with a ^{88}YBe photoneutron source. *Phys. Rev. D*, 113(11):112017, 2026. **Main Contributor**.
- [4] E. Aprile et al. First Search for Light Dark Matter in the Neutrino Fog with XENONnT. *Phys. Rev. Lett.*, 134(11):111802, 2025. **Main Contributor**.
- [5] E. Aprile et al. First Indication of Solar ^8B Neutrinos via Coherent Elastic Neutrino-Nucleus Scattering with XENONnT. *Phys. Rev. Lett.*, 133(19):191002, 2024. **Corresponding Author**.
- [6] C. Cai et al. Reactor neutrino liquid xenon coherent elastic scattering experiment. *Phys. Rev. D*, 110(7):072011, 2024. **Main Contributor**.
- [7] E. Aprile et al. The XENONnT dark matter experiment. *Eur. Phys. J. C*, 84(8):784, 2024.
- [8] E. Aprile et al. First Dark Matter Search with Nuclear Recoils from the XENONnT Experiment. *Phys. Rev. Lett.*, 131(4):041003, 2023. **Main Contributor**.
- [9] E. Aprile et al. Search for New Physics in Electronic Recoil Data from XENONnT. *Phys. Rev. Lett.*, 129(16):161805, 2022.
- [10] D. Xu et al. Towards the ultimate PMT waveform analysis for neutrino and dark matter experiments. *JINST*, 17(06):P06040, 2022. **First Author**.
- [11] J. Wen et al. GRID: a student project to monitor the transient gamma-ray sky in the multi-messenger astronomy era. *Exper. Astron.*, 48(1):77–95, 2019.